

i-UG Website Update Guide

How we make changes to the group website

Why we work this way

Our website is stored on GitHub (a free, online filing cabinet for website files) and automatically published to our live site on Azure. Nobody edits the live site directly. This keeps a full history of every change, lets more than one person help out safely and means a mistake can always be undone.

The golden rule:

- Anyone on the committee can propose a change.
- Only the Development Director can publish a change to the live site.
- Publishing then happens automatically — there is no separate “upload” step.

Technical foundation — Do not change!

This site is built as a single, one-page static website using Tailwind CSS for all styling.

This is a deliberate technical decision and must not be deviated from — no additional pages, no alternative CSS frameworks or libraries, no page builders or CMS plugins.

- One page only — all content (events, contact form, etc.) lives on the single page.
- Tailwind CSS only — don't introduce Bootstrap, custom stylesheets, inline styles from other tools, or any other styling framework.
- Static site only — no databases, no server-side code, no CMS.
- Any proposal to change this technical foundation must go through the Development Director first, separately from routine content edits.

The five-step process

Step 1 Propose A committee member opens the page on GitHub and clicks the pencil (edit) icon to suggest a change.	Step 2 Submit GitHub automatically saves this as a “pull request” — a polite request asking for the change to be reviewed.
Step 3 Review The Development Director checks the wording, formatting and accuracy and can leave comments if anything needs changing.	Step 4 Approve Once happy, the Director clicks “Merge.” This is the only step that can publish a change. Committee members cannot do this themselves.
Step 5 Publish Azure automatically rebuilds and publishes the site within a minute or two. No manual upload is ever needed.	

Step-by-step: making a small text change

1. Go to the website's GitHub page (link will be shared separately) and sign in.
2. Open the file for the section you want to change (e.g. the Events section).
3. Click the pencil icon in the top-right corner of the file to start editing.
4. Make your change directly in the text box — you're not editing the live site, just a draft copy.
5. Scroll down, add a short note describing what you changed and choose “Create a new branch and start a pull request.”
6. Click “Create pull request.” That's it — the Development Director will be notified automatically.

See the pictorial overview at the bottom of this document.

What the Development Director does

- Reviews the proposed change (GitHub shows exactly what's being added, removed or changed).
- Leaves comments if something needs adjusting and the committee member can update their submission.
- Clicks "Merge" to approve — this is the only action that pushes a change live.
- Azure then rebuilds and republishes the site automatically, usually within a minute or two.

Ground rules for content changes

- Please stick to minor content updates — event details, contact info, dates, small wording fixes.
- The site must remain a single-page static site styled with Tailwind CSS — do not add pages or other styling frameworks (see Technical foundation above).
- Anything involving new design, layout or page structure should go through the Development Director first.
- Keep event and contact details accurate and consistent with the style guidance provided separately.
- If unsure, open the pull request anyway and leave a comment — it's easy to discuss before anything goes live.

Cost saving: WordPress vs Azure free tier

Many small organisation sites are run on WordPress with paid hosting. Moving to GitHub + Azure Static Web Apps (Free tier) removes the recurring hosting bill almost entirely, because a one-page informational site has no database and no server-side processing to pay for — it's just files being handed out.

	Typical WordPress hosting	Azure Static Web Apps (Free)
Hosting	~£5–£15 / month (shared or managed WP hosting)	£0 / month
SSL certificate	Often included, sometimes a paid add-on	Included free
Security & plugin updates	Ongoing task, sometimes a paid plugin/service	Not applicable — no plugins, no database to patch
Custom domain	Usually included in hosting plan	Included free (up to 2 domains)
Approx. yearly hosting cost	~£60–£180 / year	£0 / year

What stays the same either way:

- Domain name registration (e.g. £8–£15/year) — this is separate from hosting and needed under both options.
- Someone's time to maintain content — the workflow in this guide is designed to make that easy and safe to share around.

The figures above are typical UK WordPress hosting prices for reference and will vary by provider — worth checking current invoice for an exact comparison. The main saving comes from no longer paying for a database-backed content management system when a simple one-page site doesn't need one.

Quick reference

Can propose a change: Any committee member

Can approve and publish: Development Director only

Manual Azure upload needed? No — fully automatic after approval

Pictorial Overview

